

FREE-TIER FIRST GUIDE

AI Productivity & Research Efficiency Framework

A practical system for using AI to work faster, research smarter, verify information, and turn messy inputs into accurate outputs.

Built for students, content creators, beginner researchers, freelancers, and everyday knowledge workers who want maximum efficiency without relying on paid AI plans.

What this helps you do	Core promise
Research faster	Move from question to trusted answer using a repeatable evidence workflow.
Stay accurate	Use source checks, contradiction checks, recency checks, and citation discipline.
Use free tools wisely	Match each AI tool to the job instead of wasting limits on random prompting.
Create better outputs	Turn research into briefs, notes, study guides, scripts, reports, and decision memos.

Version 1.0 | May 2026

ORIENTATION

How to use this framework

This guide is a complete operating system for using AI with discipline. It is designed for people who want to become faster and more accurate, especially when researching, studying, planning, writing, summarizing, analyzing information, and producing polished work.

The main principle is simple: do not use AI as your source of truth. Use AI as your thinking partner, search assistant, summarizer, structure builder, critic, editor, and quality-control assistant.

The framework is called FASTER AI because every stage pushes you toward speed with verification:

Stage	Meaning	Purpose
F	Frame the task	Define the goal, output, audience, deadline, and success criteria.
A	Assemble the right tools	Choose the best free-tier tool for the exact job.
S	Source the evidence	Collect credible, current, relevant sources before forming conclusions.
T	Transform the information	Summarize, compare, classify, outline, calculate, or draft.
E	Evaluate accuracy	Check citations, contradictions, missing context, and assumptions.
R	Refine the output	Turn rough AI output into a clean final answer, report, or decision.

Best way to read this guide
Use Section 3 as your daily workflow, Section 5 as your prompt library, and Section 9 as your implementation plan. If you only have 10 minutes, use the one-page sprint checklist on Page 17.

Contents

- 1. The Big Idea: AI as an operating system, not a shortcut
- 2. The Free-Tier AI Tool Stack
- 3. The FASTER AI Workflow
- 4. The Research Accuracy Protocol
- 5. The Prompt Operating System
- 6. Use-Case Playbooks
- 7. Free-Tier Maximization Rules
- 8. Implementation Plan
- 9. Templates, Checklists, and Scorecards
- 10. Source Notes

SECTION 1

The big idea: AI as an operating system

Most people use AI like a search box. That is a weak use case. The effective user treats AI like a full productivity layer that improves every stage of knowledge work: planning, searching, reading, comparing, summarizing, writing, editing, testing, and storing reusable knowledge.

The biggest mistake is asking AI for the final answer too early. That creates fast but fragile work. A stronger method is to force AI through a workflow: define the task, gather sources, reason from evidence, check itself, and produce a final output.

Bad AI habit	Why it fails	Better habit
Asking one broad question	The answer becomes generic and may miss your context.	Give context, success criteria, output format, and constraints.
Trusting the first answer	AI can sound confident even when it is wrong or incomplete.	Ask for assumptions, uncertainties, and verification steps.
Using one tool for everything	Each tool has different strengths and limits.	Use a tool stack: chat, search, source analysis, writing, and storage.
Copying without editing	Your work becomes shallow and may include hallucinations.	Use AI drafts as raw material, then verify and rewrite.

The AI productivity equation

Output quality = Task clarity x Source quality x Prompt discipline x Verification x Human judgment.

If one part is weak, the final work becomes weak. This is why this guide focuses on the system, not just prompt tricks.

The 4 roles of AI in productive work

Role	Use AI for	Do not use AI for
Strategist	Planning, decision trees, research plans, task breakdowns.	Replacing your judgment or goals.
Research assistant	Finding angles, summarizing sources, creating search queries.	Being the only source of truth.
Analyst	Comparing evidence, extracting patterns, building frameworks.	Inventing facts without evidence.
Editor	Improving clarity, structure, tone, and formatting.	Submitting unverified drafts as final work.

SECTION 2

The free-tier AI tool stack

The goal is not to use every AI tool. The goal is to build a small, reliable stack where each tool has a job. Free-tier accounts usually have limits, so the best strategy is tool specialization: use one tool for reasoning, one for search, one for source-grounded notes, one for academic papers, and one for storage.

Recommended default stack

Need	Primary free-tier option	Use it for	Best practice
General reasoning and drafting	ChatGPT Free / Gemini Free / Claude Free	Planning, summarizing, rewriting, brainstorming, comparing options.	Start with a clear brief, then ask for questions, gaps, and verification.
Web-connected research	ChatGPT web search / Microsoft Copilot / Google AI Mode / Perplexity	Current information, source discovery, quick topic mapping.	Open sources and verify claims before using them.
Source-grounded study	NotebookLM	Working with your own PDFs, notes, articles, lecture slides, and source packs.	Upload only relevant sources and ask for cited summaries.
Academic papers	Elicit / Consensus / Google Scholar	Finding studies, extracting claims, comparing evidence, identifying paper types.	Use academic tools for scientific claims, not general chat alone.
Reference storage	Zotero / Google Drive / Notion free	Saving sources, notes, PDFs, links, prompts, and reusable frameworks.	Keep a research log so you do not repeat work.
Monitoring topics	Google Alerts	Tracking new mentions, news, competitor movement, or research themes.	Create alerts for exact phrases and review weekly.

Tool selection rule

Choose the tool based on the work stage, not based on popularity.

Work stage	Best tool type	Reason
I need to understand a topic	General AI chat + web search	Good for mapping the topic, generating subquestions, and building a first outline.
I need credible sources	Search engine, Perplexity/Copilot, Google Scholar	Better for discovering sources and citations.
I have PDFs or notes	NotebookLM or file upload in a chat tool	Better for source-grounded summaries and Q&A.;
I need scientific evidence	Elicit, Consensus, Google Scholar	Better for peer-reviewed literature and study summaries.
I need a final deliverable	ChatGPT/Gemini/Claude + Docs/Word	Better for synthesis, structure, rewriting, and formatting.

Important note about free tiers

Free plans change frequently. Treat the listed tools as categories and examples, not permanent guarantees. The durable skill is the workflow: know what job each tool must perform, then use the best available free option at the time.

SECTION 3

The FASTER AI workflow

This is the core step-by-step workflow. Use it for essays, reports, content research, business decisions, project planning, market research, coding research, academic study, and product research.

Step 1: Frame the task

Before opening an AI tool, write a one-paragraph task brief. This prevents vague answers and saves free-tier usage limits.

Question	What to write
Goal	What final outcome do you need? Example: a 1,500-word report, a study guide, a comparison table, a script, a decision memo.
Audience	Who will use the output? Example: beginner students, lecturer, clients, content followers, team members.
Scope	What is included and excluded?
Standard	What makes the answer good? Example: cited, current, concise, step-by-step, evidence-based.
Deadline	How much time do you have? 15 minutes, 1 hour, 1 day, 1 week?

Copy-paste framing prompt

I need to complete the following task: [task]. My audience is [audience]. The final output should be [format]. My constraints are [time, free tools, length, topic limits]. Before answering, ask what information is missing, suggest the best workflow, and give me a research plan.

Step 2: Assemble the right tools

Pick a tool chain. A tool chain is the sequence of tools you will use, not a random collection of AI apps.

Scenario	Tool chain
Fast overview	ChatGPT/Gemini -> web search -> final summary.
Accurate report	ChatGPT/Gemini planning -> search/Copilot/Perplexity -> source notes -> NotebookLM -> final synthesis.
Academic research	Google Scholar/Elicit/Consensus -> source table -> NotebookLM or ChatGPT file analysis -> evidence summary.
Content research	Search/Google Trends/AI search -> pattern extraction -> hook/script generation -> fact check.
Business/product research	Search -> competitor/source table -> AI comparison -> decision memo -> risk review.

SECTION 3 CONTINUED

From sources to final output

Step 3: Source the evidence

Use AI to generate search queries, not just answers. Search queries are more controllable than broad questions.

Source prompt

Generate 10 precise search queries for this research question: [question]. Group them into beginner overview, recent data, expert sources, opposing views, and practical examples. Include exact phrases and alternative keywords.

Build a source table

Column	What to capture
Source title	Name of article, paper, report, video, or documentation page.
Publisher/author	Who created it and whether they are credible.
Date	Publication or updated date. Critical for fast-changing topics.
Main claim	The key point you may use.
Evidence type	Official docs, academic paper, news article, blog, expert opinion, dataset.
Reliability score	High, medium, low, or needs checking.
Quote/detail	Short exact detail or paraphrased note you may cite later.

Step 4: Transform the information

Once you have sources, use AI to transform them. Do not ask for a final answer yet. Ask for structured thinking first.

Need	Prompt pattern
Summarize	Summarize this source in 5 bullets. Separate facts, opinions, assumptions, and statistics.
Compare	Compare these sources by agreement, disagreement, evidence strength, and missing context.
Simplify	Explain this at beginner level, then intermediate level, then expert level.
Extract	Extract definitions, key claims, numbers, named entities, dates, risks, and action steps.
Outline	Create a clean outline for a report using only the source notes provided.

Step 5: Evaluate accuracy

Before finalizing, run a verification pass. This is where most people skip work and lose accuracy.

Verification prompt

Review this answer for factual risk. Identify unsupported claims, outdated details, missing sources, contradictions, weak logic, and areas where the wording sounds more confident than the evidence allows. Then rewrite it with safer wording.

Step 6: Refine the output

Convert the verified material into the final deliverable: report, study guide, script, presentation notes, table, executive summary, or action plan. Ask AI to format, not to invent new facts.

Final output formats

Output	When to use it	Best AI instruction
Executive summary	When the reader needs the answer quickly.	Give the conclusion first, then evidence, risks, and next steps.
Research brief	When you need a balanced explanation with sources.	Use headings, source-based claims, and confidence levels.
Decision memo	When comparing options or choosing a direction.	Show options, trade-offs, recommendation, unknowns, and next action.
Study guide	When learning or preparing for an exam.	Include definitions, examples, misconceptions, and practice questions.
Content script	When turning research into TikTok, YouTube, or carousel content.	Use hook, problem, value points, examples, and fact-check notes.

Refinement prompt

Turn this verified material into [output format]. Keep every important claim tied to the source notes. Improve structure, remove repetition, make the language clear, and add a short final checklist of what still needs human review.

Final human review checklist

- Check whether every important claim is supported by a source or clearly marked as an assumption.
- Remove claims that sound impressive but cannot be verified.
- Make sure dates, prices, tool limits, and current events are checked against current sources.
- Read the final output aloud once to catch awkward wording and logical jumps.
- Save the final answer, source table, and best prompts in your workspace for reuse.

The final question

Before publishing or submitting, ask: would this still be useful if someone challenged my evidence, my logic, and my assumptions? If the answer is no, return to the Evaluate step.

SECTION 4

The research accuracy protocol

Speed is useful only when the result is trustworthy. The goal is not to make AI sound smart; the goal is to reduce error. Use this protocol whenever accuracy matters.

The 6-layer accuracy check

Layer	Check	Question to ask
1. Source existence	Does every important claim have a source?	Where did this claim come from?
2. Source quality	Is the source official, expert, academic, primary, or reputable?	Is this source qualified to make the claim?

3. Date freshness	Could the fact have changed recently?	Is there a newer source?
4. Cross-check	Do at least two reliable sources agree?	What contradicts this?
5. Scope	Is the answer overgeneralizing?	Does this apply to my country, level, industry, or audience?
6. Human review	Does the final output make logical sense?	Would I defend this if questioned?

Source ladder

Reliability level	Use case	Examples
Highest	Facts about a product, policy, platform, law, data, or tool	Official documentation, government pages, primary data, company help pages.
High	Current events and industry interpretation	Reputable news outlets, expert analysis, research institutions.
Medium	Practical tutorials and experience	Blogs, YouTube tutorials, community posts, newsletters.
Low	Ideas and inspiration only	Social media posts, unverified threads, anonymous comments.

The 2-source rule

For important claims, especially claims involving money, health, law, technology updates, statistics, or current events, use at least two reliable sources. If sources disagree, state the disagreement instead of forcing one answer.

The contradiction prompt

Find the strongest counterargument to this answer. What would an expert challenge? What facts are uncertain? What would change the conclusion?

The recency prompt

Which claims in this answer could have changed in the last 6-12 months? List them and tell me exactly what should be verified online before publication.

SECTION 5

The prompt operating system

Prompts are not magic words. A strong prompt is a mini project brief. The more clearly you define the job, the less the AI has to guess.

The MASTER prompt structure

Letter	Meaning	What to include
M	Mission	What you want done.
A	Audience	Who the output is for.
S	Sources	What material or links should be used.

T	Tone	Professional, simple, academic, persuasive, beginner-friendly, etc.
E	Evidence	How citations, claims, and uncertainty should be handled.
R	Result format	Table, checklist, report, PDF outline, script, brief, comparison matrix.

Universal high-quality prompt

You are helping me complete [task]. The audience is [audience]. Use the following context: [context]. The final output should be [format]. Prioritize accuracy, clarity, and practical steps. Separate confirmed facts from assumptions. Ask for missing information only if it would significantly change the answer. Otherwise, make reasonable assumptions and state them.

Prompt upgrade checklist

- Add context: what the task is, why it matters, and what you already know.
- Add constraints: length, tone, tools, deadline, level of detail, and format.
- Add source rules: whether to use provided sources only, web sources, academic sources, or official docs.
- Add evaluation rules: ask for risks, blind spots, assumptions, and verification steps.
- Ask for structured output: tables, headings, checklists, decision trees, or templates.

Advanced prompt patterns

Pattern	Use it when	Prompt
Socratic tutor	Learning a hard topic	Teach me step by step. Ask me questions after each section before moving on.
Expert critic	Improving an idea	Challenge this idea like a strict expert. Find flaws, risks, weak assumptions, and better alternatives.
Research planner	Starting research	Create a research plan with sources to find, questions to answer, and a verification checklist.
Evidence table	Comparing sources	Turn these notes into a table with claim, source, evidence quality, and confidence level.
Final editor	Polishing work	Improve clarity and structure without adding new claims. Keep the meaning intact.

SECTION 6

Use-case playbooks

Use these playbooks when you need quick implementation. Each one gives a repeatable process and tool chain.

Playbook A: Fast topic research

- 1 Ask a general AI tool to define the topic, related terms, beginner questions, expert questions, and common misconceptions.
- 2 Ask it to generate precise search queries and source categories.
- 3 Use web search or an AI search tool to collect 5-8 sources.
- 4 Create a source table with title, date, main claim, evidence type, and reliability score.
- 5 Ask AI to synthesize the source table into a beginner-friendly explanation.

- 6 Run the verification prompt before finalizing.

Playbook B: Academic research

- 1 Turn your topic into a focused research question.
- 2 Use Google Scholar, Elicit, or Consensus to find academic papers and review articles.
- 3 Capture paper title, authors, year, study type, sample, method, findings, and limitations.
- 4 Ask AI to group papers by agreement, disagreement, and evidence strength.
- 5 Use NotebookLM or another source-grounded tool to ask questions only over uploaded papers.
- 6 Write the final answer with cautious language and citations.

Playbook C: Content creation research

- 1 Define the audience, pain point, and platform format.
- 2 Use AI search to find current trends, common questions, and repeated audience frustrations.
- 3 Ask AI to extract patterns: hooks, objections, examples, myths, and emotional triggers.
- 4 Generate 10 angles, then score them by clarity, usefulness, controversy, and shareability.
- 5 Pick one angle and create a script, carousel, thread, or newsletter outline.
- 6 Fact-check any statistic, claim, or named tool before posting.

Playbook D: Business/product research

- 1 Define the product idea, buyer, problem, and alternative solutions.
- 2 Research competitors, pricing, reviews, Reddit/forum pain points, and current tools.
- 3 Ask AI to build a competitor comparison table.
- 4 Ask AI to find gaps, weak positioning, underserved users, and risks.
- 5 Create a one-page decision memo: build, test, pause, or reject.
- 6 Validate with real users before investing heavy time or money.

SECTION 6 CONTINUED

Workflow examples

Example 1: Researching a software career path

Step	Action	AI/tool
1	Ask what the career path involves, required skills, and common beginner mistakes.	ChatGPT/Gemini/Claude
2	Search for current job descriptions and official tool docs.	Web search/Copilot/Perplexity
3	Summarize job postings into repeated requirements.	ChatGPT/Gemini
4	Create a learning roadmap and project list.	ChatGPT
5	Verify tools, versions, and market claims.	Official docs and recent sources

Example 2: Writing a research report

Step	Action	Output
1	Frame the research question and scope.	Research brief
2	Collect 8-12 credible sources.	Source table
3	Ask AI to group claims into themes.	Theme map
4	Ask AI to produce an outline using only source notes.	Report structure
5	Write draft section by section.	First draft
6	Run accuracy, contradiction, and clarity checks.	Final report

Example 3: Studying from notes

Step	Action	Prompt
1	Upload or paste notes.	Summarize these notes into core concepts, definitions, and examples.
2	Ask for explanation levels.	Explain this like I am new, then at exam level.
3	Generate practice questions.	Create 10 questions: easy, medium, difficult, scenario-based.
4	Mark answers.	Mark my answer out of 10 and explain what is missing.
5	Create active recall system.	Turn this topic into flashcards and a 30-minute study plan.

Important

For school, university, or client work, use AI to learn and improve your work. Do not submit AI output blindly. Your understanding and verification still matter.

SECTION 7

Free-tier maximization rules

Free accounts are powerful, but limits can interrupt your work. The answer is not to ask smaller questions only. The answer is to reduce waste.

The 10 rules

- 1 Plan before prompting. A 2-minute task brief can save 10 wasted prompts.
- 2 Use the right tool for the right stage. Do not spend reasoning limits on simple source discovery.
- 3 Ask AI to create a plan first, then execute section by section.
- 4 Keep a reusable prompt library so you do not rewrite the same instructions.
- 5 Batch similar tasks: summarize all sources at once, then compare them together.
- 6 Compress context: paste only relevant excerpts, not huge unrelated documents.
- 7 Ask for tables when comparing options. Tables reduce vague responses.
- 8 Ask for uncertainty and verification needs before trusting an answer.
- 9 Save final outputs and source tables in Drive, Notion, or Zotero.
- 10 Use alerts and saved searches so AI does not have to rediscover the topic every time.

Free-tier tool rotation strategy

Stage	Use	Reason
Planning	ChatGPT/Gemini/Claude	Good at task breakdown and structured thinking.
Discovery	Search/Copilot/Perplexity/Google	Better for current sources and links.
Academic evidence	Elicit/Consensus/Scholar	Better for papers and evidence type.
Source Q&A;	NotebookLM/file uploads	Better when you already have PDFs or notes.
Polish	ChatGPT/Gemini/Claude	Good for clarity, tone, formatting, and structure.

Context compression template

Here is the only context you need: [goal], [audience], [constraints], [source notes], [desired output]. Ignore unrelated background. Ask for missing information only if it would materially change the answer.

Limit-saving workflow

- 1 Prompt 1: Ask for a plan, not the final output.
- 2 Prompt 2: Provide sources or notes and ask for extraction.
- 3 Prompt 3: Ask for synthesis and contradictions.
- 4 Prompt 4: Ask for final output in required format.
- 5 Prompt 5: Ask for verification and editing.

SECTION 8

7-day implementation plan

This plan turns the framework into a working routine. It is simple enough for a beginner but strong enough for serious work.

Day	Focus	Tasks	Deliverable
1	Set up your AI workspace	Create folders for prompts, sources, outputs, and projects. Choose your default AI tools.	AI workspace
2	Build your prompt library	Save prompts for research planning, summarizing, source checking, writing, and editing.	Prompt bank
3	Create your source system	Set up a source table template in Google Sheets, Notion, or Docs.	Source table
4	Practice a 30-minute research sprint	Research one topic using the FASTER AI workflow.	Mini research brief
5	Build your verification habit	Run contradiction, recency, and source-quality checks on the mini brief.	Verified version
6	Create an output template	Design a reusable format for reports, scripts, study notes, or decision memos.	Output template
7	Review and improve	Score your process, identify bottlenecks, and refine your tool chain.	Weekly AI system

The weekly routine

Use this routine every week to keep your AI system useful instead of messy.

Time	Action
Monday	Choose 1-3 research questions or tasks for the week.
Tuesday-Wednesday	Run source discovery and build source tables.
Thursday	Synthesize notes into drafts, scripts, outlines, or reports.
Friday	Verify claims and polish outputs.
Weekend	Save best prompts, remove weak sources, and update your system.

30-minute research sprint

Minute	Action
0-5	Frame the question and define the final output.
5-10	Ask AI for search queries and source categories.
10-18	Collect 5 credible sources and capture notes.
18-24	Ask AI to synthesize themes, disagreements, and evidence strength.
24-28	Run the accuracy check.
28-30	Produce a concise final answer or next-step plan.

SECTION 9

Templates, checklists, and scorecards

Use these pages as copy-paste assets. They are designed to make the framework practical.

Template 1: Research brief

Research question: [write question]
Goal: [what decision/output this supports]
Audience: [who it is for]
Scope: [included/excluded]
Required sources: [official/academic/current/news/etc.] Output format: [report/table/script/brief/checklist]
Accuracy standard: [citations, recency, cross-checking]

Template 2: Source table

Source	Date	Claim	Evidence type	Reliability	Use?
				High / Medium / Low	Yes / No / Maybe
				High / Medium / Low	Yes / No / Maybe
				High / Medium / Low	Yes / No / Maybe

Template 3: Final answer quality score

Criterion	0	1	2
Clear goal	Unclear	Somewhat clear	Very clear
Source support	No sources	Some sources	Strong sources
Current information	Outdated/unknown	Partly checked	Checked for freshness
Balanced reasoning	One-sided	Some balance	Includes counterpoints
Actionable output	Vague	Useful	Step-by-step and practical
Final polish	Messy	Readable	Professional

Score interpretation

- 0-4: Do not use yet. Reframe the task and gather better sources.
- 5-8: Usable draft. Needs verification and structure improvement.
- 9-12: Strong output. Ready for final human review.

Template 4: Reusable verification prompt

Audit this output. Mark every claim as supported, unsupported, uncertain, outdated-risk, or needs citation. Then suggest edits that make the answer safer, clearer, and more accurate without adding unsupported claims.

SECTION 9 CONTINUED

Prompt bank

Purpose	Prompt
Research plan	Create a research plan for [topic]. Include subquestions, source types, search queries, and verification checks.
Source extraction	Extract key claims, statistics, dates, names, definitions, and limitations from this source.
Compare sources	Compare these sources. Show agreements, contradictions, stronger evidence, weaker evidence, and missing context.
Simplify	Explain this topic simply, then explain it at a more advanced level. Include examples.
Accuracy audit	Find unsupported claims, possible hallucinations, outdated details, and assumptions in this answer.
Counterargument	Challenge this conclusion. What would a strict expert or skeptical reader question?
Final rewrite	Rewrite this into a clean professional format. Keep the facts intact and do not add new claims.
Action plan	Turn this research into a step-by-step implementation plan with priorities, tools, and risks.

Decision memo template

Decision: [what must be decided]

Options: [A, B, C]

Evidence: [best supporting facts]

Risks: [what could go wrong]

Unknowns: [what still needs verification]

Recommendation: [best option and why] Next action: [what to do in the next 24-72 hours]

Research ethics and safety

- Do not use AI to fabricate citations, data, or sources.
- Do not hide AI use where disclosure is required by a school, employer, or client.
- Do not paste private, sensitive, or confidential information into tools unless you understand the privacy settings and risks.
- Do not outsource your learning completely. Use AI to improve understanding, not replace it.
- Use human judgment for high-stakes decisions. AI can support decisions; it should not be the only basis.

SECTION 10

Source notes and tool references

The tool landscape changes quickly. The notes below were used to keep this guide aligned with current public information as of May 2026. Always check the latest official pages before publishing tool limits, prices, or availability.

Tool/source	Useful current detail	Reference
ChatGPT Free	OpenAI states free users can access capabilities such as web search, data insights from uploads, image/file uploads, GPTs, image creation, and Library storage, with usage limits.	OpenAI Help Center - ChatGPT Free Tier FAQ
Gemini Free	Google lists a free Gemini plan with everyday help, Gemini app access, image generation/editing, Deep Research, Gemini Live, Canvas, Gema, NotebookLM, and 15 GB storage; higher plans increase limits.	Google Gemini - About/Plans
NotebookLM	Google positions NotebookLM as an AI research tool and writing/thinking partner for analyzing sources and clarifying complex material.	Google NotebookLM
Elicit	Elicit lists a Basic free plan with limited Research Agent access, 2 automated reports per month, unlimited search across papers, summaries, source viewing, and Zotero import.	Elicit Pricing
Microsoft Copilot	Microsoft describes Copilot free as an AI assistant using large language models to help complete tasks faster and more efficiently.	Microsoft Support
Claude	Anthropic lists a free Claude plan and paid tiers with more usage and additional features.	Claude Pricing
Google Alerts	Google Alerts can monitor sources such as news, blogs, web, video, books, discussions, and finance at different frequencies.	Google Alerts

Recommended final workflow

For most users, the best default workflow is: ChatGPT/Gemini for planning -> web or AI search for source discovery -> NotebookLM or file upload for source-grounded analysis -> ChatGPT/Gemini/Claude for synthesis -> verification prompt -> final human edit.

Final reminder

The most productive AI users are not the people with the most tools. They are the people with the clearest workflow, strongest source discipline, and best habit of turning rough AI output into verified human-quality work.

End of framework